

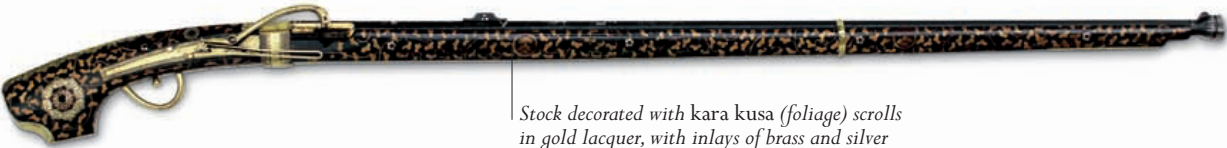
18TH-CENTURY GUNS

In 18th-century Europe, the flintlock musket was developed to a very high standard, one such example being the “Brown Bess” Land-*Pattern* musket – the weapon of choice for British infantry from 1722 to 1838. In Japan and India, however, the matchlock gun remained the dominant form of firearm. Japanese traders had come into contact with Portuguese matchlock guns in 1543, and within a few years their craftsmen had begun making weapons of this type. Because of Japan’s subsequent isolationist policies, the matchlock remained the dominant gun design until well into the 1800s. Indian matchlocks were often superbly built and featured exquisite decorations using inlaid ivory, gold, silver, or bone.

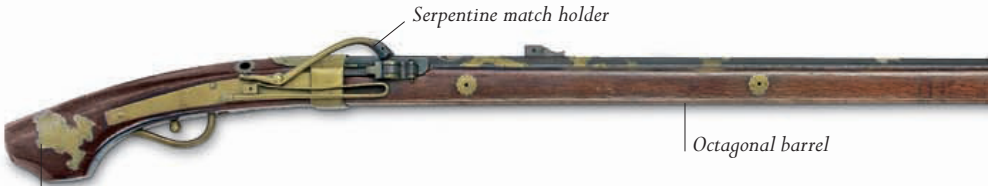
▲ JAPANESE HI NAWA JU

Date	c.1700
Origin	Japan
Weight	2.77kg (6lb)
Barrel	100cm (39¼in)
Calibre	11.4mm

This early 18th-century matchlock musket is the work of the Enami family of Sakai, widely held to be among the finest Japanese gun-makers of the preindustrial era. The stock is made of red oak, while the decoration may have been added at a later date.



Stock decorated with *kara kusa* (foliage) scrolls in gold lacquer, with inlays of brass and silver



Shishi (guardian lion) made of inlaid brass

▲ JAPANESE HI NAWA JU

Date	Early 18th century
Origin	Japan
Weight	4.14kg (9lb)
Barrel	1.03m (3½ft)
Calibre	13.3mm

Japanese *hi nawa ju* (matchlocks) could fire three bullets a minute and pierce typical samurai armour at 50m (165ft). This matchlock was made by Kunitomo Tobei Shigeyasu of Omi, western Japan. The influence of the Sakai school is evident in its red-oak stock, although it has limited decoration.



Pentagonal-section shoulder stock

Rear sight



Cock

Barrel-retaining pin

Ramrod pipe

Stock has high comb

Small of stock gripped in hand

▲ LIGHT DRAGOON FLINTLOCK CARBINE

Date	1756
Origin	England
Weight	3.3kg (7¼lb)
Barrel	91.4cm (36in)
Calibre	15-bore

British dragoons carried this carbine during the Seven Years' War (1756–63). It was a scaled-down version of the Long Land-*Pattern* musket, with a shorter barrel and in a smaller calibre.

Comb of stock to put shoulder in line of recoil



▲ PRUSSIAN RIFLED FLINTLOCK CARBINE

Date	1722
Origin	Prussia
Weight	3.37kg (7½lb)
Barrel	94cm (37in)
Calibre	15-bore

This carbine was manufactured until 1774 at the Prussian state arsenal at Potsdam (in modern-day Germany). The small of the stock is sized to fit in the hand, while the name of the armoury is stamped on the lock plate.



Trigger guard

Steel spring

▲ SEA SERVICE MUSKET

Date	Mid-18th century
Origin	England
Weight	4kg (8¾lb)
Barrel	94cm (37in)
Calibre	.75in

This English Sea Service musket is fitted with a discharger cup on the muzzle. The discharger fired cast-iron hand grenades, making this an ideal weapon for use prior to boarding.